



Re: AMD University Program Inquiry – CARP at Cal Poly SLO

From Ryan Cameron Cramer <rccramer@calpoly.edu>

Date Fri 3/13/2026 5:51 AM

To Schmidt, Andrew <Andrew.Schmidt@amd.com>

Hi Dr. Schmidt,

I had my advisor, Professor James Mealy fill out the AUP enrollment form. Once he is approved, I will have him submit the donation request.

Thank you,

Ryan

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From: Schmidt, Andrew <Andrew.Schmidt@amd.com>

Sent: Thursday, March 5, 2026 8:09:02 AM

To: Ryan Cameron Cramer <rccramer@calpoly.edu>

Subject: RE: AMD University Program Inquiry – CARP at Cal Poly SLO

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Hi Ryan,

I heard the boards are coming to Real Digital at the end of the month, but not sure how quickly I can get them to turn around and ship out. I do need a donation request from the faculty advisor. I can then follow-up and ship once available. I likely would start with 1-2 just based on short-term availability but we could discuss additional shortly after.

<https://www.amd.com/en/corporate/university-program/donation-program.html>

Best,

Andrew Schmidt, Ph.D.

[AMD University Program](#)

[Research and Advanced Development \(RAD\)](#)

Andrew.Schmidt@amd.com

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From: Ryan Cameron Cramer <rccramer@calpoly.edu>
Sent: Saturday, February 28, 2026 10:35 AM
To: Schmidt, Andrew <Andrew.Schmidt@amd.com>
Subject: Re: AMD University Program Inquiry – CARP at Cal Poly SLO

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Hi Dr. Schmidt,

Thank you for checking with Real Digital. Mid/late March would work; Cal Poly doesn't start Spring quarter until April.

Given the size of our team this year (25-30 active members), ideally having 3-6 boards would allow us to form structured sub teams and work in parallel.

That said, we are open to trying 1-2 evaluation units if that is easier from an initial program perspective. Our goal is to build long term FPGA infrastructure for students, so we want to approach this in a way that makes sense for AMD University Program as well.

Thanks again,

Ryan Cramer
President - Computer Architecture Research Project (CARP)
Cal Poly, San Luis Obispo

From: Schmidt, Andrew <Andrew.Schmidt@amd.com>
Sent: Friday, February 27, 2026 11:46 PM
To: Ryan Cameron Cramer <rccramer@calpoly.edu>
Subject: RE: AMD University Program Inquiry – CARP at Cal Poly SLO

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Hi Ryan,

I was checking with Real Digital and the next batch will be available mid/late March. If that timing is too late, we may have some other ideas, but wanted to check on your timeframe and quantity request?

Best,

Andrew Schmidt, Ph.D.

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Andrew.Schmidt@amd.com

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From: Ryan Cameron Cramer <rccramer@calpoly.edu>
Sent: Wednesday, February 25, 2026 4:23 PM
To: Schmidt, Andrew <Andrew.Schmidt@amd.com>
Subject: Re: AMD University Program Inquiry – CARP at Cal Poly SLO

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Hi Mr. Schmidt,

Thank you for following up, I really appreciate it.

The AUP-ZU3 looks like a strong fit for what we need. The combo of the ARM processor and UltraScale+ PL would allow us to explore SoC architectures in a way that aligns well with our current CARP development efforts.

I would absolutely welcome the opportunity to reconnect and discuss this further. Please let me know a time in the coming weeks that works best for you.

Best,

Ryan Cramer
President, Computer Architecture Research Project (CARP)
Cal Poly, San Luis Obispo

From: Schmidt, Andrew <Andrew.Schmidt@amd.com>
Sent: Tuesday, February 24, 2026 3:07 PM
To: Ryan Cameron Cramer <rccramer@calpoly.edu>
Subject: RE: AMD University Program Inquiry – CARP at Cal Poly SLO

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Hi Ryan,

Sorry we couldn't connect while you were here! I have more to connect on for resources for UltraScale+ but I was wondering if something like our AUP-ZU3 board would be a suitable platform? Here are a few links. Let's try and find time to talk again more in the coming weeks.

<https://www.amd.com/en/corporate/university-program/aup-boards/realdigital-aup-zu3.html>
https://xilinx.github.io/AUP-ZU3/getting_started.html
<https://www.realdigital.org/hardware/aup-zu3>

Best,

Andrew Schmidt, Ph.D.

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[Research and Advanced Development \(RAD\)](#)
Andrew.Schmidt@amd.com

[Facebook](#) | [Twitter](#) | amd.com

From: Ryan Cameron Cramer <rccramer@calpoly.edu>
Sent: Tuesday, February 24, 2026 2:18 PM
To: Schmidt, Andrew <Andrew.Schmidt@amd.com>
Subject: AMD University Program Inquiry – CARP at Cal Poly SLO

You don't often get email from rccramer@calpoly.edu. [Learn why this is important](#)

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Hi Mr. Schmidt,

I hope you are doing well. My name is Ryan Cramer. My colleague Robert Burns and I originally met you at ISFPGA 2025, where we had the opportunity to speak about CARP and our work at Cal Poly. That conversation ultimately led to AMD generously supporting one of our capstone projects with a Kria K26 platform, for which we are very grateful.

I attended ISFPGA again last week in 2026 and saw that you were there as well, but unfortunately, we did not get a chance to reconnect in person. I wanted to follow up regarding the AMD University Program and potential opportunities to continue building our relationship.

I serve as President of the [Computer Architecture Research Project \(CARP\)](#) at Cal Poly, San Luis Obispo. CARP is a student-led research initiative focused on processor design, FPGA prototyping, ASIC flows, and hardware security. Our mission is to build real, silicon-grade systems while training students in strong digital design methodology aligned with industry practice.

We are currently running several FPGA-based efforts, including custom RISC-V cores, accelerator prototypes, and hardware security platforms. The Kria K26 has been instrumental in supporting our embedded and edge AI work. As our organization continues to grow, we are looking to expand into larger-scale prototyping efforts.

Specifically, we are interested in gaining access to UltraScale or UltraScale+ class hardware, such as Kintex or Virtex platforms, to support projects involving PCIe, high-speed interfaces, memory subsystems, and multicore architectures. Access to this level of FPGA would allow our students to prototype systems that more closely reflect modern data center and high-performance compute environments.

We would greatly appreciate the opportunity to discuss potential hardware support, evaluation boards, surplus development kits, or other partnership pathways through AMD. Our goal is to

build long-term technical depth while showcasing AMD platforms in student research, capstone projects, and conference demonstrations.

If you would be open to a brief call, I would be grateful for the opportunity to share more about CARP and our roadmap for the coming year.

Thank you again for your continued support of student innovation.

Best regards,
Ryan Cramer
President, Computer Architecture Research Project (CARP)
Cal Poly, San Luis Obispo